

Esteban *Gimenez Zapiola*

CREATIVE DIRECTOR & CREATIVE AI LEAD · BCG

Sydney, Australia · working globally

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I run design as a business that drives revenue,
and I built the Creative AI practice that scales it:
33 nodes, a lab of 10, 24 builders in squads.

As Creative Director at BCG I own the ANZ Creative Studio P&L, sit on the global leadership team, and lead Creative AI across **33 nodes** and a **global lab of 10**, with reach into 400+ designers. I work **embedded in the case team**, hands-on with MDPs, BCG X engineers and the client's own technical people.

I build agentic AI myself and take it to production. The building is how I lead: I write the first working version so there is something real to argue with, then hand it to the people who take it further.

Design isn't art. It's a discipline that moves revenue.

EXPERIENCE

Nov 2024 – Present

BCG · Boston
Consulting Group

Sydney · Global

Creative Director & Creative AI Lead

- Founded and lead BCG Design Studios' **Creative AI practice**. Wrote the *"Creative Advantage"* proposal that made it the firm's Creative AI centre of excellence.
- Lead **33 Creative AI nodes across the regions** and a **global lab of 10 creative technologists**. I designed the structure, defined the roles and wrote the playbook, so a node runs without me.
- **Orchestrated 24 builders across squads** to ship a seven-product suite for senior partners, with handover docs and named owners in other regions.
- Designed the **Power Up Weeks** and run them through the regional leads. I write and teach the deep dives: graph and context engineering, prompting, agent loops, building agents in Claude and GPT. Ran a **global Creative AI hackathon** end to end, now a shared library of **49 skills** behind an automated review pipeline.
- **The only creative director in Design Studios running a global Creative AI programme while also delivering client work hands-on with ANZ case teams**. I lead the coded proof-of-concept **inside the pitch, not after it**, working with MDPs, **BCG X data scientists and engineers** and the client's own technical team. **Multiple proposals won that way** across agri-food, energy, convenience retail, beverages and banking. The win is never one person's. It takes BCG strategy plus design and creative craft.
- For an **aviation ground-services operator in Asia**, delivered the whole proposal: a pitch site, a film, and a **working product POC connected to real data**. Client-approved.
- Build and ship **agentic AI hands-on**: multi-agent systems, MCP servers, autonomous agents, an AI video pipeline, and a report engine that typesets long-form publications straight from the source. **Parla**, the native macOS dictation app I built from scratch, is now in daily use by BCGers well beyond my team and scaling across the firm.
- Lead the global practice across **six disciplines** and **400+ designers**, own the **ANZ Creative Studio P&L**, and sit on the global Design Studios leadership team. Hold BCG's *"Grow by Growing Others"* award. Pitched, launched and executive-produce **Business and Beyond**, BCG ANZ's flagship video podcast.
- **Outcomes**: 9–13% YoY revenue growth · ~2× regional scale · ~80% cross-border delivery · double-digit conversion lifts.

Nov 2021 – Oct 2024

BCG · Boston
Consulting Group

Sydney

Senior Creative Manager

Head of Creative ANZ & Co-Lead, Strategy ANZ. Built the foundation for the Global role.

- Grew ANZ Creative into one of BCG's strongest regional design practices; creative strategy contributing to **9–13% YoY revenue growth** across financial services, energy, retail, public sector, healthcare and tech.
- Co-led ANZ business strategy, at the table for positioning, growth and investment decisions; partnered with MDs, Partners and C-suite to shape transformation programs. Ran design as a commercial lever.
- Began embedding AI into the creative workflow, and grew senior designers into the leadership bench that earned the Global mandate.

Jun 2018 – Nov 2021

Endeavour Group

Sydney

Creative Lead, Endeavour Drinks · *Dan Murphy's*

Creative Lead for Dan Murphy's, Australia's #1 drinks retailer; also BWS, Jimmy Brings and MilkRun.

- Sat on the **division leadership team** and helped grow the in-house team **from 4 people to 30**, into a full in-house agency serving the whole Endeavour portfolio, with up to **6 senior creatives** reporting to me.
- Built and governed the Dan Murphy's **Design System** (Frontify, InVision), the single source of truth for print, digital and coded templates.
- Led the danmurphys.com.au **restyling** ($\approx 2\times$ audience) and the **Dan Murphy's app** launch; created sub-brands incl. Dan's Run (UberEats), Direct to Boot and Dan's Cellar.
- Led and mentored a team of 6 senior designers, and was the kind of leader people wanted to work for.

Jun 2015 – Jun 2018

Endeavour Group

Sydney

Senior Digital Designer

In-house digital at agency pace, across Dan Murphy's, BWS, Langtons and Cellarmasters. Leading junior designers from the start.

- Hand-coded EDM templates and implemented dynamic personalisation on Oracle Responsys, the foundation of Dan Murphy's segmented email program.
- Produced wireframes and restyled core components of danmurphys.com.au; led art direction and on-location shoots for tier-1 campaigns, lifting digital ROI.

Aug 2011 – Aug 2015

Kasiopea · Brand Chemistry

Buenos Aires · Sydney

Senior UX/UI Designer

Generalist principal at a Buenos Aires digital agency (pharma, energy, talent, tech): art director, UX/UI designer, front-end developer, client lead and new-business pitcher. Clients incl. Duke Energy, Engie and Farmacity. Bridged to Brand Chemistry, Sydney.

2009 – 2012

Mendioroz Design · Crested Butte

Buenos Aires · Colorado

Graphic Designer · *Ski Instructor*

Visual identity and **wayfinding** for airports and shopping centres: signage systems, technical documentation and supplier oversight, where my interest in how design lives in physical space began. Plus three winter seasons as a PSIA-certified ski instructor, coaching beginners with patience.

CAPABILITIES

- i. Agentic AI, hands-on** · multi-agent systems, MCP servers, autonomous agents, a native app, prototype to production.
- ii. Building the practice, not just the tool** · 33 nodes, a lab of 10 technologists, and 24 builders across squads who shipped a seven-product suite at my direction; playbooks and handover docs so it runs without me.
- iii. Teaching it so it sticks** · Power Up Weeks run region by region, plus the deep dives I write and deliver.
- iv. Design leadership at scale** · high-trust teams across regions and disciplines, coaching leaders into exceptional ones, across apps, websites, design systems, brand, journeys, editorial and motion.
- v. Strategic partnership & commercial design** · shoulder-to-shoulder with case teams, MDPs and the C-suite; owning a studio P&L, creative as a balance-sheet asset.

HONOURS

Grow by Growing *Others*

BOSTON CONSULTING GROUP

BCG award for leaders who lift the people around them: mentorship, and growing senior talent into leaders.

Ironman World Championship (*Hawaii*)

ELITE-AMATEUR TRIATHLETE

Multiple Ironman 70.3 age-group wins; qualified for the World Championship.

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Mini-MBA, Business of Creativity · Future London Academy · 2025

Branding Now II · Future London Academy · 2022

Lic. Diseño de Imagen Empresaria & Diseñador Gráfico · Univ. de Palermo · 2009-13

Español (native) · English (full professional)